



PARAGRAPHS



LEARNING OBJECTIVES

At the end of the lesson, you should be able to:

- Identify and establish a clear central theme in a paragraph, ensuring that all sentences within the paragraph relate to and support that theme.
- Create coherence in your paragraphs by organising ideas in a logical and orderly manner, using cohesive links such as connectives to connect and clarify relationships between sentences.
- Use techniques such as paraphrasing and contrasting sentences to emphasise key ideas within a paragraph, effectively highlighting their significance.





PARAGRAPHS

Paragraphs represent individual units of thought within a written composition. In an essay, they serve as discrete segments of discourse, with the expectation that each paragraph maintains independence while contributing to the collective meaning of the entire essay through its connection to other paragraphs.





PARAGRAPHS

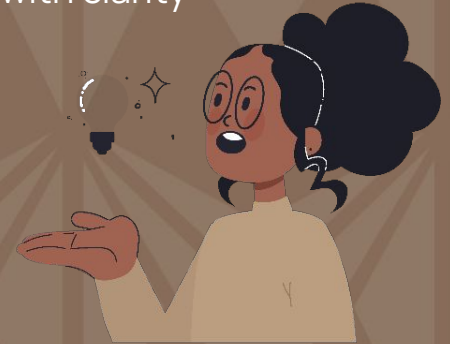
The fundamental purpose of paragraphs is to uphold the structural integrity of our essays. Hence, a well-constructed paragraph should include a topic sentence, which serves as the sentence highlighting the key message of that particular paragraph.





PARAGRAPHS

Paragraphs are the building blocks of effective writing, providing structure and coherence to our thoughts. In academic and professional communication, the ability to construct well-organised paragraphs is essential for conveying ideas with clarity and precision.

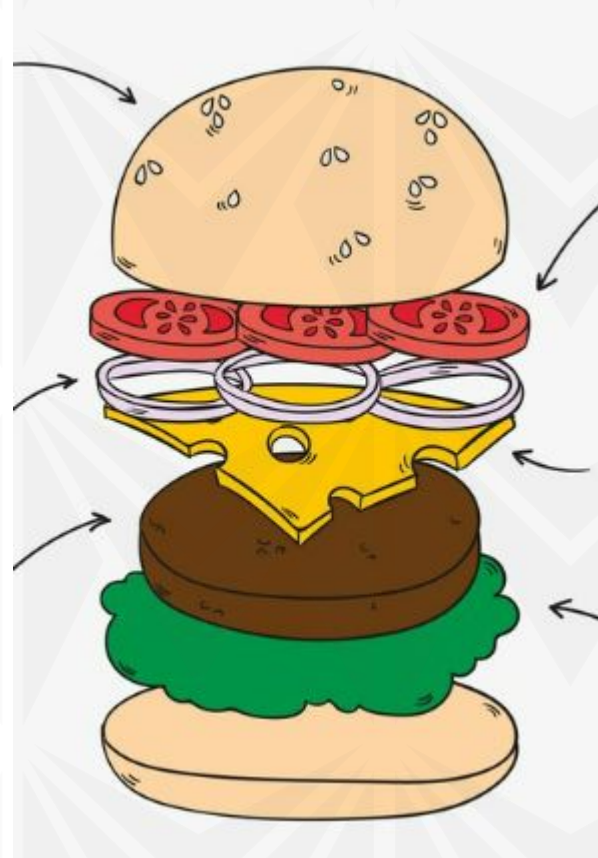




PARAGRAPHS

Paragraphs are the bedrock of any writing. They are so important that they help readers focus on the points being discussed.

Look at this burger! It looks yummy, right? What exactly do you think is yummy about it? The filling, right? Yeah. That's exactly what a paragraph is.





PARAGRAPHS

The most important part of any essay or academic writing is the paragraph because it carries all the juicy details, just like the filling of a burger.





COMPONENTS OF A GOOD PARAGRAPH

- Unity
- Coherence
- Topic sentence
- One idea at a time

In various literature, when you search “what makes a good paragraph?” you’d find various components. But one component remains constant, “Topic sentence”.





PARAGRAPH: UNITY

Unity in a paragraph requires a singular central theme, with all sentences relating to this theme to fulfill the paragraph's purpose. Avoiding digression is essential for maintaining a coordinated and focused essay.





PARAGRAPH: COHERENCE

Achieving paragraph coherence involves ensuring meaningful contributions from all parts, including lexical and syntactic structures. Orderly and logically connected ideas, facilitated by cohesive links like conjunctions and pronouns to prevent monotony and ambiguity, are crucial for enhancing overall clarity in the essay.

Coherence in a paragraph is essential to ensuring that its ideas and sentences flow smoothly and logically.





PARAGRAPH: COHERENCE

Here's an example of a paragraph that lacks coherence:

"In the morning, I woke up early to go for a run. The sun was shining brightly in the sky. My favourite breakfast is pancakes with maple syrup. After my run, I went to the park to read a book. I love spending time outdoors."

While each sentence in this paragraph makes sense on its own, they don't connect well to create a coherent paragraph.





PARAGRAPH: COHERENCE

Here's a revised version that improves coherence:

"In the morning, I woke up early to go for a run. The sun was shining brightly in the sky, casting a warm glow on the neighbourhood. After my energising run, I returned home and prepared my favourite breakfast: fluffy pancakes drizzled with rich maple syrup. With a satisfied appetite and a clear mind, I headed to the nearby park, where I could enjoy my book amidst the soothing sounds of nature. I've always found solace in spending time outdoors."

In this revised paragraph, the sentences are connected in a logical sequence, making it more coherent. It flows smoothly from waking up to running, having breakfast, and going to the park, creating a unified and understandable narrative.





ONE IDEA AT A TIME

Paragraphs should focus on one idea exclusively, ensuring that any point introduced is fully discussed within that paragraph. Transitioning from one paragraph to another should not involve the continuation of a point. For example, when presenting the advantages and disadvantages of a situation, all points regarding advantages should be covered in one paragraph, and similarly, all points on disadvantages should be discussed in a separate paragraph.





PARAGRAPH: TOPIC SENTENCE

Topic sentences play a crucial role in effective writing by serving as the main idea or central point of a paragraph. They provide a clear and concise preview of what the paragraph will discuss, guiding readers and helping them understand the content's focus.

A well-crafted topic sentence not only introduces the main idea but also establishes the overall purpose and direction of the paragraph. It acts as a roadmap, allowing readers to anticipate the information that follows and aiding in the comprehension of the text. Strong topic sentences are often positioned at the beginning of a paragraph, setting the tone and guiding readers through a logical flow of ideas. Ultimately, the clarity and coherence of topic sentences contribute significantly to the overall structure and readability of written works.





PARAGRAPH: TOPIC SENTENCE

Every paragraph must have a topic sentence that succinctly presents the *main idea* or *argument*, serving as a reader's guide and offering a clear direction for the paragraph's content.

The topic sentence is often found at the beginning of a paragraph. Sometimes in the models or at the end of each paragraph.

Note that if there are five paragraphs in an essay, there must be five topic sentences. This is why we say that each paragraph must talk about one idea.





PARAGRAPH: SUPPORTING SENTENCES

A topic sentence also has supporting details. Since the topic sentence is just one sentence, then the other sentences in the paragraph will support or add more details to the topic sentence; this is why the other sentences are called *supporting details or supporting sentences*.





PARAGRAPH: TOPIC & SUPPORTING SENTENCES

Body Positivity

The concept of body positivity, encouraging self-acceptance and diverse body appreciation, has become a subject of controversy in recent times. Advocates argue that body positivity challenges societal norms, combating body shaming and unrealistic beauty standards. Critics claim that the movement may unintentionally normalise unhealthy lifestyles, fostering the idea that all body sizes are equally healthy. Debates surround concerns about potential exclusions within body positivity, particularly regarding individuals with disabilities or those facing health challenges. Ongoing discussions center on the complex impact of the body positivity movement on mental health, societal perceptions, and overall well-being.





PARAGRAPH: TOPIC & SUPPORTING SENTENCES

Body Positivity

Topic
sentence

The concept of body positivity, encouraging self-acceptance and diverse body appreciation, has become a subject of controversy in recent times. Advocates argue that body positivity challenges societal norms, combating body shaming and unrealistic beauty standards. Critics claim that the movement may unintentionally normalise unhealthy lifestyles, fostering the idea that all body sizes are equally healthy. Debates surround concerns about potential exclusions within body positivity, particularly regarding individuals with disabilities or those facing health challenges. Ongoing discussions center on the complex impact of the body positivity movement on mental health, societal perceptions, and overall well-being.

Supporting
sentences





PARAGRAPHS: TRANSITION WORDS

Another important aspect of a paragraph is the use of transitional words like:

- Additionally
- Furthermore
- Moreover
- However
- Nevertheless
- On the contrary



TRANSITION WORDS & PHRASES - MORE EXAMPLES

Addition	Contrast	Comparison	Cause and Effect	Emphasis
Additionally	However	Similarly	Therefore	Indeed
Furthermore	Nevertheless	Likewise	Thus	Certainly
Moreover	On the contrary	In the same way	Consequently	Specifically
In addition	Conversely	Just as	As a result	In particular
Likewise	In contrast	Compared to	Accordingly	Especially
Not only... but also	Although	Like	Because	Above all





TRANSITIONAL WORDS & PHRASES - MORE EXAMPLES

Sequence/ Order	Illustration/ Example	Conclusion/ Summary	Time	Clarification
First, second, ...	For example	In conclusion	Meanwhile	In other words
Next	For instance	To sum up	During	To clarify
Then	Namely	Overall	Simultaneously	That is to say
Afterward	In particular	In summary	Eventually	Specifically
Meanwhile	Such as	Consequently	In the meantime	Namely
Finally				In simpler terms





PARAGRAPHS: TRANSITION WORDS

Spot the transition words or phrases in the paragraph below:

Climate change is a pressing global issue that requires immediate attention. Firstly, the burning of fossil fuels, such as coal and oil, releases greenhouse gases into the atmosphere, leading to rising temperatures. Consequently, this warming effect causes the polar ice caps to melt, resulting in sea level rise and coastal erosion. Furthermore, extreme weather events like hurricanes and droughts have become more frequent and severe due to these changes. In conclusion, addressing climate change through sustainable practices and reducing carbon emissions is imperative to mitigate its destructive impacts on our planet and future generations.



PARAGRAPHS: TRANSITION WORDS

*Climate change is a pressing global issue that requires immediate attention. **Firstly**, the burning of fossil fuels, **such as** coal and oil, releases greenhouse gases into the atmosphere, leading to rising temperatures. **Consequently**, this warming effect causes the polar ice caps to melt, resulting in sea level rise and coastal erosion. **Furthermore**, extreme weather events like hurricanes and droughts have become more frequent and severe due to these changes. **In conclusion**, addressing climate change through sustainable practices and reducing carbon emissions is imperative to mitigate its destructive impacts on our planet and future generations.*





PARAGRAPHS

In conclusion, crafting paragraphs is not just about words; it's an art form. It's about creating a symphony of ideas that keeps readers engaged.

Paragraphs can make or break your writing. So choose to stick with the correct way of writing paragraphs.





SUMMARY

Today's lesson was about paragraphs – those essential chunks of writing that help organise our thoughts. We learned that each paragraph needs a strong leader, the "topic sentence," to guide readers through the main idea. The key is to keep paragraphs focused on one main idea, avoiding any wandering thoughts.

But it's not just about having a topic sentence; we discussed how paragraphs come to life with supporting details, examples, or evidence. It's about painting a complete picture for the reader.

And then there's the art of transitions – making sure our paragraphs connect seamlessly, creating a smooth flow.





REFERENCE & FURTHER READING

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THANK
YOU